

GEO & AEO

Content Optimisation Intake

Complete each section to enable AI-optimised copy, schema markup, semantic phrase guides, and content architecture for your website and earned media.

Section 1

Business & brand fundamentals

Core identity — who you are and what you do

These answers underpin every piece of optimised content. Be as precise as possible — vague inputs produce vague outputs.

1.1 What is the full legal name of the business or brand?

1.2 What trading names, product names, or sub-brands should also be recognised?

1.3 In one sentence, what does the business do and for whom?

Think: "We help [audience] do [outcome] by [method]." This becomes your AI-readable boilerplate.

1.4 What sector or industry do you operate in?

Include sub-sectors if relevant. This shapes schema markup and entity classification.

1.5 Where does the business operate? (geography)

List all countries, regions, or cities. Local entity signals are critical for GEO.

1.6 How long has the business been operating, and what are its key trust signals?

e.g. founding year, accreditations, awards, notable clients, media coverage, certifications

1.7 Who are your primary competitors? (optional but valuable)

Helps calibrate entity differentiation in AI model training contexts.

Section 2

GEO vs AEO priority assessment

Determine which optimisation approach should lead

GEO (Generative Engine Optimisation) focuses on being cited by AI systems like ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini. AEO (Answer Engine Optimisation) focuses on appearing in direct-answer features — AI Overviews, featured snippets, voice search. These questions identify your priority weighting.

BUSINESS MODEL SIGNALS

2.1 What is your primary sales or conversion path?

- People find us via search, read our website, and contact us or buy directly
- People discover us through press, podcasts, social, or word of mouth, then research us
- We rely heavily on being recommended by AI tools (e.g. ChatGPT, Perplexity) or voice assistants
- We are a local / regional business where map and local search is critical
- A mix — describe in the space above

2.2 How do your best customers typically find you for the first time?

Rank the top 3 channels if you know them.

2.3 Are your customers making quick transactional decisions or longer considered purchases?

- Quick / transactional (minutes to hours)
- Considered (days to weeks — research-heavy)
- Complex / enterprise (months, multiple stakeholders)

CONTENT & VISIBILITY SIGNALS

2.4 Do you currently produce thought leadership, guides, reports, or commentary that others cite or link to?

- Yes, regularly and it performs well
- Yes, but inconsistently
- No — this is new territory for us

2.5 Have you noticed your brand mentioned in AI-generated answers? (e.g. ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude)

If yes — what context? Which tools? What is said?

2.6 What questions do your customers most commonly ask before buying? List up to 10.

These become the backbone of your AEO FAQ and answer-first content strategy.

2.7 Are there industry questions or topics where you have unique expertise or data?

GEO depends on your being the authoritative source AI models draw from. These are your GEO opportunity.

Section 3

Audience & intent mapping

Who you're talking to and what they need to hear

AI engines retrieve content that best matches user intent — not just keywords. Defining your audiences and the language they use is essential for both GEO and AEO.

3.1 Describe your primary audience(s). Who are they and what is their role or context?

Include job title, seniority, sector, or life stage as relevant. List multiple audiences separately.

3.2 What language does each audience use when searching for your solutions?

Include informal, colloquial, and category-level terms — not just your preferred terminology. These populate your semantic phrase guide.

3.3 What are the most common pain points, frustrations, or unmet needs your audience has before finding you?

3.4 What outcome does your audience most want to achieve by using your product or service?

Section 4

Earned media — message framework

Boilerplate, message hierarchy & semantic phrase guide for outgoing content

Earned media is one of the highest-authority signals for GEO. AI models are trained on the open web — a well-placed article in a credible outlet is more powerful than any on-site SEO tactic. This section builds the messaging architecture for all outbound content.

CORE BOILERPLATE

4.1 Write — or draft the raw ingredients for — a 50-word company description (boilerplate) for press use.

Needs to include: what you do, who for, where, and what makes you distinctive. Don't worry about polish.

4.2 What is the single most important thing you want journalists, editors, or AI systems to associate with your brand?

This is your primary message — the one truth you would fight to keep in every piece of coverage.

MESSAGE HIERARCHY

4.3 List your secondary messages — the 3–5 supporting proof points that back up your primary message.

Each should be a factual, concrete claim. Avoid superlatives. AI systems prefer verifiable statements.

4.4 What proof, data, or evidence supports these messages?

Statistics, case studies, awards, certifications, third-party validation. These dramatically increase AI citation likelihood.

4.5 Are there messages or framings you actively want to avoid or move away from?

e.g. outdated positioning, competitor comparisons, phrases that feel off-brand

SEMANTIC PHRASE GUIDE — EARNED MEDIA

4.6 What are the preferred terms, phrases, and category descriptors you want associated with your brand in media coverage?

Include: category labels, technology descriptors, industry terms. These anchor AI entity recognition.

4.7 What topics or themes should your spokespeople and contributed content regularly address?

These become your GEO content pillars — the thematic territories where you want AI to see you as an authority.

4.8 Who are your spokespeople for media? List name, title, and area of expertise.

4.9 **What media outlets, publications, or platforms most influence your target audience?**

These are your priority earned media targets. Coverage here carries the most GEO weight.

Section 5

Website content architecture

Answer-first copy, key takeaways & FAQ structure

AEO-optimised web pages lead with the answer, not the build-up. AI systems scan pages for direct, structured responses — pages that bury the answer in paragraph four are invisible to AI Overviews and voice search.

CORE WEBSITE DESCRIPTION

5.1 **Write a 25-word homepage descriptor — the clearest possible statement of what you offer and who it's for.**

This anchors your H1 and meta description strategy. Prioritise clarity over creativity.

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5.2 **List each core product or service. For each: name, one-sentence description, and primary audience.**

SEMANTIC PHRASE GUIDE — WEBSITE

5.3 **For each product or service area, list the search phrases and questions your audience uses to find solutions like yours.**

Think in questions as well as keywords — "how do I track stock across multiple shops?" is as important as "inventory software UK".

ANSWER-FIRST PAGE COPY

5.4 **For your homepage and each key landing page, what is the single question that page must answer?**

Every page should be the best answer to one specific question. This shapes H1 tags and opening paragraphs.

5.5 What is the one fact, outcome, or claim each page must communicate in its first 100 words?

AEO depends on the answer appearing near the top of the page. Do not save the best for last.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

5.6 List the 5–8 most important facts about your business that every page visitor should leave knowing.

These become structured key takeaways, summary boxes, and schema-ready content. State them as complete sentences.

Section 6

FAQ page — facts, policies & common questions

AEO-ready answers to what your audience actually asks

FAQ pages with FAQ Schema markup are one of the most reliable AEO tactics. Google's AI Overviews and voice search assistants regularly pull directly from FAQ content. The quality of these answers — factual, direct, concise — determines whether your content is cited or skipped.

6.1 What are the top 10–15 questions customers ask before buying or signing up?

For each, write the question exactly as a customer would ask it — and provide the ideal answer in 2–4 sentences.

6.2 What questions do customers ask after they become clients? (support, operations, technical)

These often reveal unmet informational needs that Google is actively serving.

6.3 What misconceptions or objections do prospects commonly have about your product, service, or category?

Misconception-busting content scores highly in AI answers because it addresses real ambiguity.

6.4 List any industry or category questions your business is uniquely qualified to answer (even if not directly about your product).

These are GEO gold — becoming the go-to source for category questions builds AI-model authority over time.

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Section 7

Schema markup & technical signals

Organization schema, robots.txt, AI crawlers & structured data

Schema markup translates your content into machine-readable data that AI systems process directly. Without it, AI models have to infer — which means inconsistency, omission, and sometimes error.

ORGANIZATION SCHEMA

7.1 Registered business name, company number, and registered address

Required for Organization schema. Must match Companies House or equivalent registry.

7.2 Website URL, primary phone number, and primary email address

7.3 Social media profile URLs (all active channels)

These link your schema entity to verified external profiles, strengthening entity recognition.

7.4 Do you have a Wikidata entry, Wikipedia page, or Crunchbase profile?

These are high-authority entity anchors for AI models. If none exist, this is worth creating.

- ☐ Yes — provide URLs below
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

AI CRAWLER ACCESS

7.5 Do you know which AI crawlers currently have access to your website via robots.txt?

Key AI crawlers: GPTBot (OpenAI), ClaudeBot (Anthropic), Google-Extended, PerplexityBot, CCBot. Blocking them prevents your content being learned from.

- ☐ Yes — all are allowed
- ☐ Yes — some are blocked (specify below)
- ☐ No — we have not checked
- ☐ We want to selectively control access

7.6 Are there areas of your website you would not want AI crawlers to access?

e.g. client portals, pricing pages with dynamic content, staging environments.

7.7 List your most important website pages and their current H1 tags (if known).

H1–H3 tags are primary signals for AI content parsing. Each H1 should directly answer a search query. We will audit and rewrite these as part of the optimisation process.

Section 8**Source truth audit**

Consistency check across all existing content & citations

AI models build their understanding of your brand from multiple sources — your website, press coverage, directory listings, social profiles, and third-party reviews. Inconsistency between these sources confuses AI entity recognition and dilutes your authority.

8.1 Is your business name, address, and phone number (NAP) consistent across all online directories, Google Business Profile, and your website?

- ☐ Yes — fully consistent
- ☐ Mostly — some older listings may be outdated
- ☐ No — there are known inconsistencies
- ☐ We do not know

8.2 Has the business changed its name, address, product names, or core description in the last 3 years?

If yes, older content may still be ranking or being cited with outdated information — a critical GEO risk.

- ☐ No changes
- ☐ Yes — describe below

8.3 List the third-party sites where your business is most prominently mentioned or reviewed.

e.g. G2, Trustpilot, Capterra, industry directories, trade association pages. These are external authority signals for AI models.

8.4 Are there known inaccuracies in how your business is described or categorised on third-party sites?

8.5 Is there a single canonical brand description document that all internal teams use as the source of truth?

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- Yes — provide link or paste it below
- No — this needs to be created as part of this project

8.6 Any other information, context, or materials you would like to share?

e.g. existing brand guidelines, previous press coverage, competitor content you admire, content you want to move away from

Return completed form to begin your GEO & AEO optimisation project.

All answers are treated as confidential and used solely to inform content strategy.